

PREMIUM

Refusal Decision Guide

Judicial review, reapplying, and what actually changes the outcome

Understand your options after a refusal

Outcome	What it means	What you can do
Refusal	The IRCC visa officer wasn't satisfied you met the requirements - most commonly, temporary intent or financial evidence.	No formal appeal for a refused TRV. Your options are a fresh application, or - in narrow circumstances - judicial review.
Judicial Review	A Federal Court process reviewing whether the officer's decision was legally or procedurally sound - not a re-assessment of your case on the merits, and requires the Court's leave (permission) to proceed, within a strict deadline.	Best suited to a genuine legal or procedural error, not simply disagreeing with the outcome - consider professional advice before pursuing this.
Reapplication	A new application, assessed fresh.	The most common and usually most effective path - but only if something material has actually changed or the weak point is now properly addressed.

If you plan to reapply: what actually helps

- Read your refusal letter (the “refusal reasons”) closely and address the specific concern raised, not just the application in general
- Strengthen whichever element was weak - clearer financial evidence, a more specific itinerary, better-documented ties at home
- If financial evidence was the issue, build a longer, more consistent statement history rather than a single larger deposit
- Consider a brief cover letter explaining what's changed since the refusal (see the Cover Letter templates, Complete tier)

What not to do

- Don't reapply immediately with an unchanged application
- Don't omit a previous refusal on a later application, from Canada or elsewhere

- Don't submit materially false information to work around a previous refusal

When to seek professional advice

Consider consulting a Regulated Canadian Immigration Consultant (RCIC) or immigration lawyer if you've been refused multiple times despite genuinely strengthening your case, if you believe the refusal involved a genuine procedural error, or if your case involves more complex immigration history.